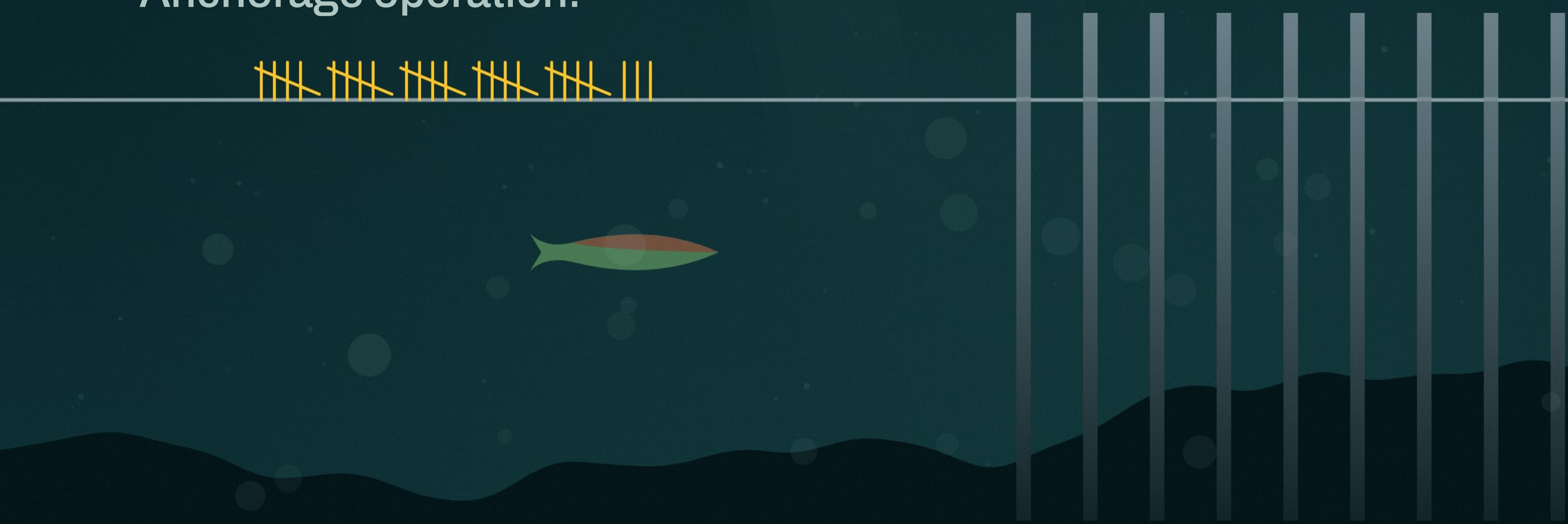
Alaska still counts its salmon by eye.

One fish at a time. This series breaks down real wins with targeted AI, and what they honestly mean for an Anchorage operation.

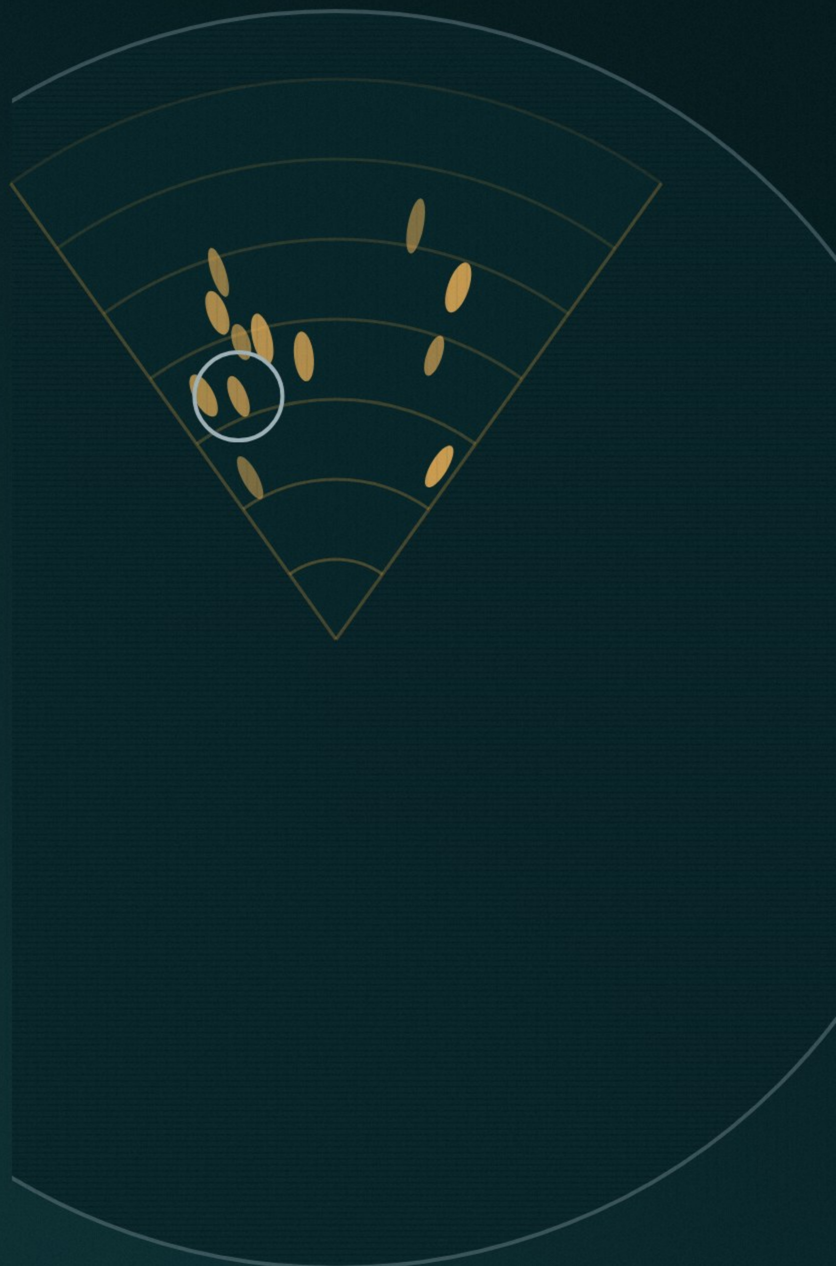


57°N · REDOUBT LAKE · SOCKEYE SEASON

The job today

A technician watches sonar video and counts fish by eye. The state calls it labor and time intensive. Weirs and towers where water runs clear. Sonar where it runs silty.

SOURCE ADF&G



ARIS IMAGING SONAR

Swap the river for an intake line or a gate. Same job.

1 HR OF VIDEO

The machine arrives

SalmonVision counts salmon from underwater camera video. Sixteen sites across Alaska and BC in 2025, over 20 projects now, the program's figure. Trained on over 5 million labeled frames.

16 SITES 2025

20 PLUS PROJECTS NOW

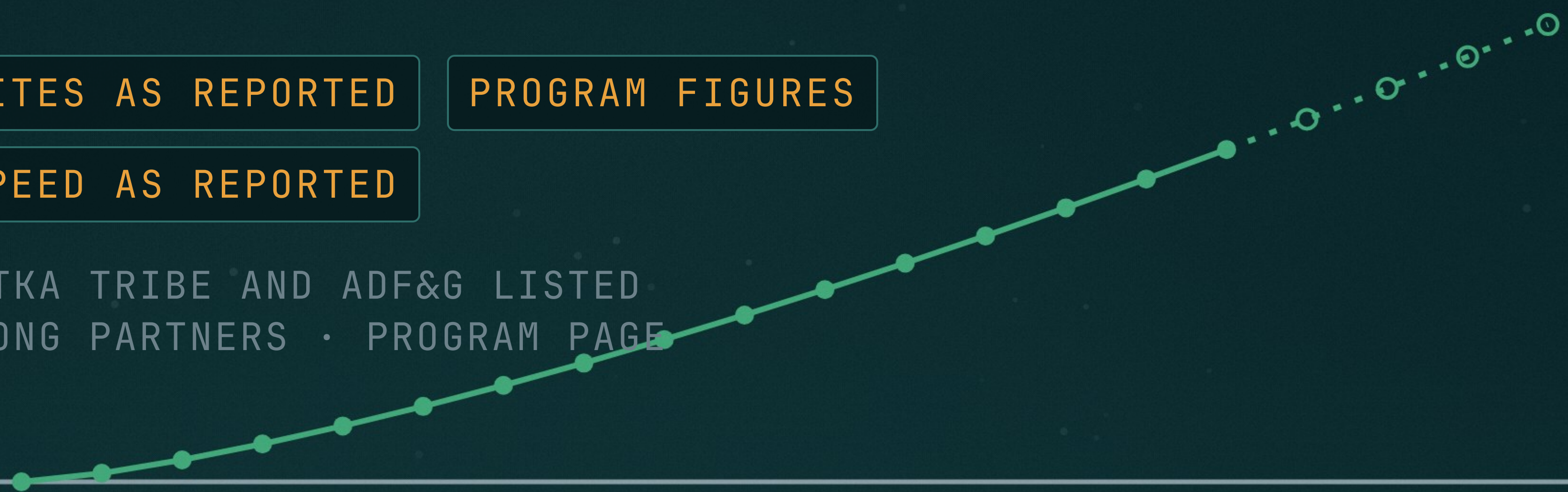
ABOUT 1 MIN TO READ

SITES AS REPORTED

PROGRAM FIGURES

SPEED AS REPORTED

SITKA TRIBE AND ADF&G LISTED
AMONG PARTNERS · PROGRAM PAGE



EACH DOT STANDS FOR MANY FRAMES

Redoubt Lake, told straight

8,111

SOURCE ADF&G RELEASE

PROPOSED

sockeye counted through the physical weir by June 29 2025

The Forest Service ran out of weir money in February 2024. A 200,000 dollar tribal grant proposes AI video. The count still came through steel.

GRANT AS REPORTED

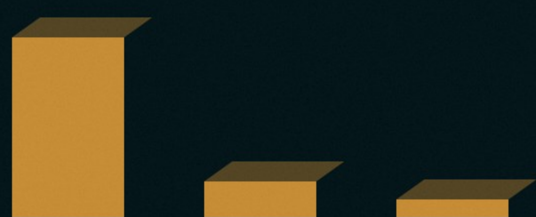
WEIR RUN BY USFS

> "Video weirs tend to reduce migration delays fairly dramatically, when compared to sort of traditional trap-associated weirs."
>
> Dr William Atlas, senior salmon watershed scientist, Wild Salmon Center

The receipts

8,111	sockeye through the Redoubt weir, 2025	ADF&G
16 to 20 plus	sites in 2025, projects now	REPORTED
5 million plus	labeled frames behind the model	PROGRAM
$50k to $10k	rig cost with edge box, video only about $5k	REPORTED
60 to 1	an hour of video, about a minute to read	REPORTED
in hours	NOAA bycatch review, versus days to weeks of human review	NOAA

Save this. Every number wears its source.
Next, the part these numbers do not say.



The catch

90 percent
species detection
PROGRAM

80.2 mAP
current model
PROGRAM

67.6 mAP
earlier benchmark, over 90 coho, over 80 sockeye
RESEARCH

Different measurements. Do not average them.

About a 23 percent count error on Kenai sonar, a February 2025 preprint. Feasibility, not a solved problem.

RESEARCH

BRISTOL BAY DRONE · VALIDATION AGAINST TOWER COUNTS IS A NEXT PHASE

Clear water counts well. Sonar stays hard. The proven win today is review time.

Your count

Seafood intake and QC

the literal twin, same fish, same July crunch

WORKFLOW RUNG

Cargo and dock counts

if a scan already captures it, plain software wins

RULES FIRST

Gates and yards

a beam sensor often beats a camera

SENSOR FIRST

Inspection footage

the model flags, a person confirms

WORKFLOW RUNG

No trusted baseline, no eval, no promise. Run it beside your human count for about 90 days.

The camera got cheap.
The trust still has to be built.

We do this kind of analysis for Alaska businesses, free. If you want your operation looked at this way, say the word.

Sources ride in the first comment.